JACOB CONLON

IT Director • Software Architecture, Cloud Modernization & AI Enablement

Cherry Hill, NJ 08003 • 856-996-5627 • Jacob@Conlon.us • conlon.us • linkedin.com/in/jacobconlon

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Technology leader who turns the hardest business problems into engineered solutions. 19+ years building and modernizing enterprise software in financial services, currently directing a **15-person team** of architects, engineers, and QA. A rare combination of deep technical command — .NET Core, Angular, cloud, and AI — and forensic accounting fluency, trusted by executive leadership to bridge IT and Finance on legacy migrations, GAAP→IFRS conversions, and enterprise AI adoption. Repeatedly delivers on time, on budget, and where competitors have failed.

SELECTED ACHIEVEMENTS

- Modeled and migrated a **25-year-old legacy lease accounting system during the global pandemic** — a modernization peer institutions attempted and failed to complete. The platform carries a **$2.2B lease portfolio across 90,000 accounts and 290,000 active agreements**.
- Engineered a novel lease-syndication solution during a GAAP→IFRS accounting transition, **eliminating a projected $1M project cost**.
- As **AI-assisted development champion**, built **ProcTuner** — an AI agent that refactors underperforming SQL stored procedures, then automatically validates data parity and benchmarks the result before promoting. **Some procedures gained 70%+ performance**.
- **Driving cloud modernization and right-sizing** — containerizing .NET Core services, migrating from Windows to Linux hosts, and adopting serverless deployments.
- Stood up modern application monitoring and observability that surfaces production issues in real time.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CANON FINANCIAL SERVICES, INC. (subsidiary of Canon U.S.A.) **12/2007 – Present**

IT Director, Corporate IT *2019 – Present*

Own IT application strategy, architecture, delivery, and platform support; lead a **15-person team** of architects, engineers, and QA. Report to executive leadership.

- Modernized the legacy “green-screen” leasing platform to a modern web/API system — multi-year program delivered on time and on budget.
- Founded an IT Architecture Committee and instituted code-review standards, strengthening security, performance, and standards adherence while reducing defects reaching QA.
- Established a continuous platform-improvement model focused on process automation and quality-of-life enhancements.
- Serve as IT owner for **SOX and J-SOX controls**, embedding compliance into the secure SDLC.

Senior IT Manager, Applications & Systems

Provided technical leadership for a team of 15 developers, architects, and QA.

- Launched a new short-term inventory-financing line of business on an external SaaS platform — increased revenue and displaced competitor volume.
- Delivered a lease setup/booking application that **cut manual data entry by 60%+**, lowered cost-to-serve, and created a framework for dealer data-feed integration.
- Replaced paper interdepartmental monetary requests with an electronic approval workflow — dynamic authority matrix and automated posting to backend leasing systems.
- Built a Unified Desktop web app consolidating multiple internal and third-party systems, improving usability and cutting new-hire onboarding time.
- Implemented Salesforce Service Console integrated with telephony and backend data for full call-center visibility and control.

Application Development Manager

Mentored and led an 8-member development team in close partnership with Project Management.

- Built a risk-based credit decision engine that **lifted auto-approval rates from 8% to 50%+**.
- Delivered a customer self-service portal (payments, account servicing) integrated with the core lease-settlement system — raised payment-application rates and reduced inbound call volume.
- Shipped a multi-device dealer portal that increased credit-application volume from the independent dealer channel.
- Led gap analysis and integration that enabled a successful merger with an acquired financial-services company.
- Introduced TDD/BDD (nUnit, SpecFlow) and Selenium automated UI testing.

Team Lead / Senior Engineer / Engineer

- Built a reusable .NET framework (Oracle/SQL Server data access, authentication, encryption, messaging, EDI, logging) adopted as the standard for all new applications.

VISION APPRAISAL TECHNOLOGY 9/2001 – 12/2007

Senior Developer / Information Systems

- Owned full-lifecycle design and development of enterprise, database-driven applications for the Computer-Assisted Mass Appraisal (CAMA) industry.
- Served as technical project manager and lead developer for the New York City, Washington D.C., and Boston deployments.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Engineering: .NET Core / C#, Angular, JavaScript / jQuery, HTML5, Entity Framework / LINQ, REST / Web API
Cloud & Infrastructure: Multi-cloud strategy — AWS (EC2), Google Cloud (containers, Vertex AI), Azure (Azure OpenAI); Docker / Docker Compose; Azure DevOps CI/CD; reverse proxy; F5 load balancing with SSL offloading; Linux
AI & LLM Engineering: GitHub Copilot (Visual Studio), Google Gemini CLI; AI agent design; built ProcTuner for automated SQL refactoring with data-parity validation and performance benchmarking
Data: SQL Server, Oracle; T-SQL, PL/SQL; ETL; query & performance tuning; data-model-first design
Security & Compliance: IT owner for SOX & J-SOX controls; application encryption; secure SDLC
Integration & Architecture: Microservices & monolithic architectures; SOAP, WCF, and JSON / REST services; EDI, SaaS, and Salesforce integration; solution & enterprise architecture; design patterns; Agile / Scrum; TDD / BDD; code-review governance
Domain: IT–Finance partnership; forensic accounting; financial-services lending platforms

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

- M.S., Information Systems — University of Phoenix, 2012
- B.A., History — College of the Holy Cross, 2001
- Certified Lease & Finance Professional (CLFP), 2018 • Certified ScrumMaster, Scrum Alliance, 2010
- Six Sigma Green Belt, Villanova University, 2010 • Microsoft Certified Application Developer (C#)
- Canon Leadership Institute, 2017